

PBC 4th Week 2026 — Staff Handbook

June 28 — July 4, 2026

The Greatest Moment — The Miracle in Your Life

WELCOME

Welcome to 4th Week

Whether this is your first summer at 4th Week or your twentieth, **welcome** — you're part of the family now. Some of us have been coming since we were campers ourselves; some of you are brand new this year. Both matter, and both are needed.

This handbook is your map for the week. If you're a veteran, give it a skim to catch what's changed this year. If you're new, read it closely. Either way, **make yourself familiar with camp procedures before the campers arrive** — the schedule, waterfront and game-room rules, emergency and lockdown steps, and your own assignments.

The expectations in here apply to **everyone — campers and staff alike**. Knowing them (and living them) is what keeps camp both safe and fun. We get to do something rare this week: work hard, laugh a lot, and watch God work — all at the same time.

The whole point: we're here for the kids. Every shift, every clean-up, every late-night cabin devo is about pointing a camper toward Jesus. When a call isn't obvious, that's your tiebreaker — do the thing that serves the campers.

When in doubt, ask a Head Counselor or a Director. Nobody expects you to have it all memorized — they expect you to care, show up on time, and ask.

Our Values

We believe in a great God. *Your ways, God, are holy. What god is as great as our God? — Psalm 77:13.* There are no limits to what God can accomplish this week!

We love God, our campers & one another. *Dear friends, let us love one another, for love comes from God. — 1 John 4:7.* We will be a place that models love for God & for one another.

We will expect & think the best of one another. *Be devoted to one another in love. Honor one another above yourselves. — Romans 12:10.* Our love & respect will overflow to campers & staff.

We will laugh. *Then we laughed with our mouths, and we sang with our tongues. — Psalm 126:2.* We want everyone to have fun & always serve with a smile.

We will do our best. *Whatever you do, whether in word or deed, do it all in the name of the Lord Jesus. — Colossians 3:17.* We will work hard & serve God with excellence.

We will honor God. *...with one mind and one voice you may glorify the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. — Romans 15:6.* God alone gets the glory for any good thing that happens 4th Week.

Our Mission

The mission of 4th Week PBC 2026 is:

- To draw campers & staff to deeper faith in Jesus Christ.
- To model Christ-like character to our campers & staff.
- To provide a safe & loving environment for campers & staff.
- To serve our campers & staff with excellence.

A Closing Word

Dear 4th Week Family,

As we close out another wonderful week at PBC, I want to take a moment to thank each of you. The long hours, the early mornings, the late nights in the cabins, the thousand small kindnesses no one noticed — none of it was wasted. God sees every bit of it, and so do the campers whose lives you touched this week.

Camp is never just about a week. Seeds get planted here that will bear fruit long after the cabins are cleaned and the buses have left. Some of you may never know, this side of heaven, which of your words or prayers or quiet examples made the difference for a camper. But trust that they did.

Travel home safely. Rest well. Carry what you learned here back into your families, your churches, and your everyday lives. And know that you are deeply loved and prayed for.

May the LORD bless you and keep you; may the LORD make his face shine on you and be gracious to you; may the LORD turn his face toward you and give you peace.

In Him,

Ethan Brown

WORKING AT CAMP

Waterfront & Swim Guidelines

Paul and Rachel Carr, Camp Lifeguards, are in charge of waterfront activities. Please follow their instructions.

- Everyone using canoes or paddle boats wears a life jacket — **including staff, NO EXCEPTIONS.**
- Juniors must be accompanied by a senior or an adult to go out on a canoe or paddle boat.
- No horseplay on the boats or the pier area — we take the danger of water seriously.
- When there are lines, limit campers' time on the boats so everyone gets a turn.
- At close, staff on duty secure the paddle boats, rack the canoes, put away life jackets, and clean up the dock area.
- You may switch shift times with another staff member if needed — tell Paul and Rachel Carr about any change, and be on time for your shift.

No lifeguard — no waterfront! A lifeguard must be on duty whenever the waterfront is open. In case of storms or lightning, the waterfront closes immediately; lifeguards can close it any time they judge it unsafe.

Your waterfront and swim shift assignments are in the Day and Staff tabs.

Game Room Guidelines

- Oversee the area to ensure safe play. Zero tolerance for destruction or damage of camp property.
- Use the electric blower or vacuum to clear debris and trash before and after play.
- Make sure campers and staff dispose of trash properly — this area has been a litter problem in the past.
- Monitor behavior.
- You may switch shift times with another staff member if needed. Please be on time.

Game room shift assignments are in the Day and Staff tabs.

Quartermaster Guidelines

The Quartermaster checks out game equipment, fishing rods and materials, pool table supplies, and ping pong equipment.

- Ensure all equipment checked out is returned.
- If equipment comes back damaged, determine how it was damaged and take the camper's name for possible repayment.
- Oversee the games area; inspect regularly and enlist camper help to keep it garbage-free.
- Lock the Quartermaster's shack when you leave.
- Shift swaps are fine — inform Zac Hermann of any schedule change, and be on time.

Quartermaster shift assignments are in the Day and Staff tabs.

Mealtime Campus Coverage

Work with the security team to supervise the campus during mealtimes — one group at the Ark area, one at the Lakefront.

- Ensure campers who have finished their meals are in approved camp areas.
- Maintain a presence around the waterfront for camper safety.
- Keep campers out of cabins unless they have counselor approval — and a counselor must accompany them.
- **Eat your meals first** so you are available during mealtimes.
- If you can't cover your shift, find a replacement.

Meal patrol assignments are in the Day and Staff tabs.

Bathhouse Evening Coverage

Work with the security team to supervise the area outside the bathhouse during assigned times.

- Ensure campers are moving to where they should be (to/from bathhouse, to/from nurse, etc.).
- Maintain a presence outside the bathhouse for camper safety.
- The evening schedule often shifts — coordinate with the other assigned staff to cover the full shower window, even when campers go to cabins earlier or later than usual.
- If you can't cover your shift, find a replacement.

Bathhouse patrol assignments are in the Day and Staff tabs.

Camp Clean-Up & Close-Out

Daily Camp Cleaning

- Each cabin cleans the grounds from their cabin to the road (front and back) and halfway to the next cabin. Cabins 1 and 6-8 also clean to the road on the far side; Cabins 11 and 12 divide the open grounds around their cabins.
- Common areas around the bathhouse, lakefront, and ARC are cleaned daily right after rest time by two scheduled cabins (girls' cabin: lakefront + bathhouse grounds; boys' cabin: ARC including upstairs, Miniature Golf, Gazebo Swings, and surrounding grounds).
- All campers tidy the ARC each evening after chapel; Security cleans the arcade and upstairs after lights out, and periodically cleans all shelters.

Friday Afternoon and Night

- A staff meeting during rest/free time plans Saturday cleanup. Volunteers are needed for: Dining Hall & Kitchen sweeping/mopping (4 adults) · Bathhouse (3 men, 3 women) · Staff Cabin (1-2 men, 1-2 women) & Staff Trailer (1-2 men).
- Each cabin gets a Saturday inspection time. Breakfast start/stop and a bathhouse closing time are set; alternate bathrooms are designated.
- After the meeting, an assigned staff member per cabin fills cleaning bottles and stocks toilet paper and towels.
- At bedtime, each cabin distributes unclaimed towels and clothes to the right campers.

Saturday Morning (before breakfast)

- Campers bring luggage to their cabin's designated spot in the ARC so cabins are empty for cleanup. Unclaimed items go to the grass hill beside the bathhouse for parents.
- Starting around 8:00 AM, the caretaker and designated staff inspect each cabin. Thumbs up → campers and staff go to breakfast; the director or designee locks the cabin.
- By 9:30 AM all cleaning and breakfast should be done, ready for final assembly and departure around 10:30 AM.

Directors and Head Counselors remain on campus until camp is fully turned over to the Week 5 Director. The kitchen & bathhouse clean-up rotation by cabin is in the Staff tab.

RULES & CONDUCT

Camper Responsibilities

Counselors — please review these with your campers. They are for everyone's safety and enjoyment. We are glad you are at 4th Week PBC & we want you to have fun!

Cabins

- Clean your cabin and the area around it daily.
- No leaving your cabin after lights out. If you need the bathhouse, a counselor must accompany you.
- Don't enter another cabin without permission from both counselors. Boys may not enter girls' cabins, and girls may not enter boys' cabins.

Around the Camp

- Stay within the boundaries of camp.
- The waterfront is only open at specified times, with a lifeguard on duty. Respect the Lifeguard's authority. Juniors must be with a senior camper (13+) or staff. Everyone wears a life jacket, even on the dock.
- Check in with your counselor at every assembly and official event.
- Cell phones and personal electronics stay in your cabin — otherwise staff will hold them until the end of the week.
- Damage to camp property will not be tolerated; you'll be responsible for repair or replacement costs.

Taking Care of Yourself and Others

- Your counselors and staff are here for you — reach out with any special needs or issues!
- If you take medication, report to the nurse during mealtimes or before bed.
- Treat counselors, staff, and fellow campers with respect and dignity.
- Public displays of affection are limited to holding hands and putting your arm around one another.
- Modest clothing is required — no see-through, fishnet, midriff-bearing, or otherwise revealing clothing. 'Inappropriate' can mean the style of a garment or a message printed on it. If asked to change, please cooperate.

These will result in campers being sent home: physical violence · alcohol, tobacco, or illicit drugs · cabin raids · leaving your cabin after lights out without permission · going to off-limits places · stealing · repeatedly ignoring camp rules.

Counselor & Staff Responsibilities

Staff Conduct

- You are responsible for the campers assigned to you. **You are the adult — act like it at all times.**
- Work well with fellow staff. If you have suggestions, share them — we are family and want to do the best job possible.
- Modest clothing is required: no see-through, fishnet, or midriff-bearing tops. Tasteful sleeveless shirts are permitted for females; males may not wear sleeveless shirts. If asked to change, please cooperate — no one wants to be the clothing police. Let's set a great example!
- Campers can't have cell phones, so use good judgment about yours. Unplug. Be with God. Be present with one another. Be there for the campers.
- No staff member leaves camp without the Camp Director's permission.
- **ZERO tolerance** for alcohol or firearms on camp premises. Smoking and tobacco are prohibited.
- Public displays of affection are limited to holding hands and putting your arm around one another.
- Follow the rules yourself — we are examples. Show up for all assignments, on time.
- Throughout the day, mingle and get to know campers. Don't stick with the same campers or only with staff — reach out to everyone.
- If you see a visitor on campus, greet them & ask them to check in with security, Roman Thomas, and/or Ethan Brown, Clint Hyden, Steve Reynolds, or Amanda Martin.
- We are here for the campers — and HAVE FUN!

The Campers

- Be a friend to the campers — be willing to serve them in any way, at any time.
- If a camper expresses interest in baptism, a Bible study guide is available. Let Ethan Brown, Clint Hyden, Amanda Martin, or Steve Reynolds know a study is being done.
- Maintain discipline, but let the campers have a good time.
- Know where your campers are. Check-ins at assemblies should include visual & physical contact, confirming all campers are present.
- Watch that your campers eat at every meal & encourage plenty of water.
- Prepare cabin devotionals each evening.
- Get campers to bed as close to lights out as possible — rest matters for health and attitudes.
- Use positive guidance — redirection, positive reinforcement, encouragement — rather than comparison or criticism.
- Discipline problems go first to the lead counselor in the cabin, then to the Head Boys/Girls Counselor (Steve Reynolds or Amanda Martin), who will notify the Camp Directors.
- If you see, hear, or feel anything wrong or out of the ordinary, notify a Head Counselor or Camp Director immediately.
- Report all accidents, illnesses, or injuries immediately to the camp nurse, who logs all incidents.
- Make sure all campers stay within camp perimeters.

Staff will not abuse children in any way — physical (striking, spanking, slapping, shaking), verbal (humiliating, degrading, threatening speech), sexual (touching or speaking inappropriately), mental (shaming, withholding kindness, cruelty), or neglect (withholding food, water, or basic care). This may be cause for immediate dismissal from camp.

NEVER be alone with a camper you are disciplining — have another staff member present. **NEVER** be alone with a camper of the opposite sex. **NEVER!** Failure to abide by this rule will send you home.

EMERGENCIES

Emergency: Medical Response

Upon learning of a medical incident, broadcast a radio call that the medical response team is needed. **The location and apparent nature of the incident are the most important details.** Do not broadcast names of the injured or your assessment of their condition.

Designated responders: Tammy Duzan, Deena Thomas, Andy McClellan, or Shane Brown. For Waterfront incidents, also Paul Carr and/or Rachel Carr.

- Designated responders go immediately to the location. The first to arrive becomes **Incident Commander** and begins assessment and treatment.
- When a staff member with medical training arrives, the Incident Commander turns over control and assists as directed.
- Whoever is operating the golf cart or gas-powered vehicle goes immediately to the nurse's cabin to provide transportation for the nurse, then follows the Incident Commander's instructions.
- For all other injuries, the Incident Commander arranges transport to the Nurse's cabin if needed.

For a potentially life-threatening injury, call 911 immediately.

We do not have the skills or equipment for advanced first aid if someone unstable deteriorates during transport.

Emergency: Lockdown Procedures

Lockdown is initiated for: hazardous weather · a potentially dangerous animal (any wild animal or aggressive dog) · a non-camp individual who won't respond to staff directions or becomes confrontational · anyone carrying a weapon onto camp · any situation the Director judges to put campers at sufficient risk.

The lockdown signal is THREE blasts from the air horn.

Counselors take campers to the cabin, secure the doors, and gather everyone in the innermost part away from windows until "all clear." A **FOURTH, longer blast** means danger is imminent or a weapon is on camp. Security confirms receipt by radio.

- Non-essential staff return to the staff cabins. Essential staff and Security respond to the cafeteria/office area.
- **Bears:** bears have the right of way — avoid contact. A bear on campus is likely after food scraps; we go into lockdown as a precaution. Security will use the air horn and firecrackers to scare it off (per SC DNR guidance). If it won't leave, we call the SC DNR hotline — dispatch may take up to an hour.
- **Snakes:** report all sightings to Security immediately. Venomous snakes have been seen in the area. Snakes will be captured and relocated by the designated staff member.

Spiritual Conversations: How & Why

If you watch Jesus closely, one thing he often does is **ask questions**. When people asked Jesus a question, he seldom answered directly — he asked questions of his own.

Good questions are one of our most powerful tools:

- **Questions make us think.** Asking invites someone to think alongside you.
- **Questions work at different layers of openness** — Interests, Values, and Core/Worldview. We can't force a conversation deep, but a good question extends the invitation.
- **Questions show we care.** Asking signals that what they say matters — and that they matter.
- **Questions draw us closer.** Listening that makes someone feel truly heard demonstrates love and builds real friendship.

A spiritual conversation is like a dance — let your partner take the lead. Only go as deep as the camper wants to go. A camper has the right to say "No," and you have the obligation to respect their will. Worldview questions work best after real time at the interests and values levels first.

These lists are prompts, not rules or straitjackets. Let them prod your thinking as you reach into the lives of these young people to bless them with the love of Christ.

Questions for Junior Campers

Juniors are concrete thinkers — help them think about God through stories and relationships, not abstract concepts.

Interests

- What's your favorite thing to do when you're not in school?
- What's a movie or show you could watch over and over again?
- If you could be really, really good at one sport or game, what would it be?
- What's the best meal your family makes?
- What's your favorite animal, and why do you like it?

Values

- Which is better — pizza or tacos / Minecraft or Roblox / dogs or cats? Why?
- If you could go anywhere on vacation, where would you go and what would you do there?
- Who's someone you really look up to — a family member, athlete, or character in a story?
- If you could meet one famous person (real or from a movie or book), who would it be and what would you ask them?

Core / Worldview

- What's one thing that would make you feel really happy no matter what else was going wrong?
- What do you think happens after we die?
- Has anyone ever talked to you about God? What did they say?
- Do you ever pray? What do you say when you do?
- What do you think makes a person a really good person on the inside?

Questions for Senior Campers

Seniors want to be seen, taken seriously, and treated like their ideas matter. Frame questions as genuinely curious, not leading.

Interests

- What do you do with your free time when no one is telling you what to do?
- What's a show, podcast, or YouTube channel you're into right now?
- What subject at school feels pointless to you — and what's one you actually care about?
- What kind of music do you listen to, and what do you like about it?

Values

- Which matters more to you — being liked or being respected / being comfortable or being challenged / loyalty or honesty? Why?
- Who's someone you genuinely admire and want to be like? What is it about them?
- If you could have a long conversation with anyone — alive or dead — who would it be and what would you want to know?
- What's something most people your age care about that you think is kind of overrated?

Core / Worldview

- If you lost everything — relationships, achievements, plans — what's the one thing that would make you say "I'm still going to be okay"?
- What do you think gives life actual meaning, not just the answer you're supposed to give?
- Do you think there's something spiritual to you — a soul, or something beyond just your body and brain? What do you think it's like?
- What's your honest opinion of religion or church — not what you're supposed to say, but what you actually think?
- Is there a version of faith or God that you could actually believe in, or does it all feel impossible to you?
- What's something people get wrong about who you are or what you believe?

Questions that keep a conversation going

- Tell me more about that?
- What do you mean?
- How did that make you feel?
- Why is that important to you?
- What will you do if that happens / doesn't happen?

If a camper expresses interest in baptism, a study guide will be provided — see Counselor & Staff Responsibilities.

Weekly Menu

Menu is subject to change. Notify the kitchen of any camper allergies or dietary needs.

SATURDAY · 6/27

Breakfast

Muffins · Cereal · Milk/Coffee

Lunch

No lunch

Dinner

Staff: BBQ at Welcome Meeting · Campers: Lasagna, Garlic Bread, Side Salad, Apple & Peach Cobbler

SUNDAY · 6/28

Breakfast

Cinnamon Rolls · Protein · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

Chicken & Rice Casserole · Side Salad · Cookies

Dinner

Turkey & Dressing · Mashed Potatoes · Rolls · Green Beans · Cranberry Sauce · Side Salad · Brownies

MONDAY · 6/29

Breakfast

Ham/Egg/Cheese Croissant · Cereal · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

Chicken Sandwich · Fries · Rice Krispie Treat · Garnish bar

Dinner

Spaghetti w/ Meat Sauce · Garlic Bread · Salad · Banana Pudding

TUESDAY · 6/30

Breakfast

Pancakes · Sausage · Cereal · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

Pizza · Salad Bar · Jello

Dinner

Roast Beef · Rice · Rolls · Green Beans · Gravy · Side Salad · Choc Cake w/ Buttercream

WEDNESDAY · 7/1

Breakfast

Scrambled Eggs · Bacon · Hash Browns · Cereal · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

Water Day sack lunch: Ham & Cheese Sliders · Chips · Granola Bar · Fruit Cup

Dinner

Chicken Tenders · Baked Potato · Roasted Broccoli · Salad · Cheesecake w/ Cherries

THURSDAY · 7/2

Breakfast

Biscuits & Gravy · Sausage · Jelly · Cereal · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

Chicken Quesadilla · Rice · Refried Beans · Garnish Bar · Oreos

Dinner

Cookout: Hamburgers & Hot Dogs · Baked Beans · Mac & Cheese · Garnish Trays · Chips · Strawberry Shortcake

FRIDAY · 7/3

Breakfast

French Toast Sticks · Bacon · Cereal · Fruit · Juice/Milk/Coffee

Lunch

BBQ on Hawaiian Roll · Chips · Pudding Cup · Salad

Dinner

Taco Salad · Canned Corn · Salad Bar w/ Toppings · Cake w/ Fudge Icing